

7. Limestone for manufacture of cement
8. As roofing tiles in the form of slates



3.1.4 Characteristics of Good Building Stones

Following are the characteristics of good building stone:

1. **Crushing Strength** : For a good structural stone, the crushing strength should be greater than 100 N/mm^2.
2. **Appearance** : The stones which are to be used for face work, should be decent in appearance and they should be capable of preserving their colour uniformly for a long time. The colour of the stones for face work should be chosen by keeping in mind the general get up of the surrounding area.
3. **Durability :** A good building stone should be durable. The various factors contributing the durability of a stone are its chemical composition, texture, resistance to atmosphere and other influences, location of the structure, etc.

   The important atmospheric agency which affect the durability of a stone is alternate conditions of heat and cold due to difference in temperature.
4. **Dressing of Stones**: Stones should be such that they can be easily carved, moulded out and dressed. Dressing of stones results in economy of construction.
5. **Fracture :** For a good building stone, its fracture should be sharp, even, bright and clear with grains, well cemented together. A dull, chalkey and earthly fracture of a stone, reduces the life span of the building.
6. **Hardness** : The co-efficient of hardness, as worked out in hardness test should be greater than 17 for a stone to be used in road work. If it is between 14 and 17, the stone is said to be of medium hardness.
7. **Attrition** : In attrition test, if wear is more than 3%, the stone is not satisfactory. If it is equal to 3%, the stone is just tolerable.
8. **Fire Resistance** : The minerals composing stone should be fire resistant in such a way that the shape is preserved when a fire occurs.
9. **Seasoning :** The stones should be well seasoned before putting into use. The stones obtained fresh from a quarry, contain some moisture which is known as the quarry sap. The presence of this moisture makes the stone soft.
10. **Specific Gravity** : For good building stone, the specific gravity should be greater than 2.7 or so.
11. **Texture** : A good building stone should have compact, fine, crystalline structure free from cavities, cracks or patches of soft or loose material. These stones with such texture are strong and durable.
12. **Water Absorption** : All the stones are more or less porous, but for a good stone, percentage of water absorption by weight should not exceed 0.60 after 24 hours immersion in water.

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